

Specials Brand Mapping Guide

How to configure `brand_import_mappings.json` to automatically map a supplier's specials file into the Import Specials screen.

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Overview

When you click **Import...** on the Specials tab, the app reads the supplier's spreadsheet and maps its columns into the standard specials grid (Barcode, Description, Special Price, MultiBuy Qty, etc.). For most one-off files this is done manually via the *Columns* panel on the right.

For brands that send specials in a consistent, named-column format (such as Green Cross Health), you can define a **brand mapping** in

```
brand_import_mappings.json
```

Once configured, selecting the brand and clicking Import will automatically populate the grid — no manual column selection required.

The mapping also drives several derived fields that cannot come directly from a column:

- Group ID (which rows belong to the same multi-product deal)
- Get Lowest Free flag
- Flybuys flag
- Special Name and date pickers (auto-filled from the file's first row)

File location

`brand_import_mappings.json` sits in the same folder as `PriceFileApp.exe` :

```
brand_import_mappings.json  ← same level as PriceFileApp.exe
```

The file is not bundled inside the `.exe` — it lives alongside it in the application folder and can be opened and edited with any text editor at any time.

✓ No rebuild needed — changes take effect next time the app loads the file.

⚠ JSON is strict about syntax. Use a code editor such as VS Code for editing; it will flag any missing commas, mismatched brackets, or stray characters before you save.

How it works

1 — Brand name lookup

When you select a brand in the Import Specials screen, the app looks up the brand's *display name* (as it appears in the Brand dropdown) in the JSON file. The key must match exactly, including capitalisation.

```
// The brand name in the dropdown is "GXH"  
"GXH": { // ← key must match exactly  
  ...  
}
```

Price File Builder — Specials Brand Mapping Guide — Last updated April 2026 — `brand_import_mappings.json`
is now editable without rebuild